

WFLOW-08: JavaScript & HTTP Actions

Series: WFLOW — Workflows and Alert Notifications | **Notebook:** 8 of 10 |
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Custom Code and API Integration

When built-in actions aren't enough, use JavaScript and HTTP requests for custom integrations. This notebook covers the JavaScript SDK, HTTP request patterns, and common integration scenarios.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Dynatrace Environment	SaaS with Platform subscription

Requirement	Details
Permissions	automation:workflows:write
Prior Knowledge	WFLOW-01 through WFLOW-07, JavaScript basics

1. JavaScript Action Basics

Action Structure

```
// Every JavaScript action must export a default async function
export default async function(context) {
  // context contains:
  // - event(): trigger event data
  // - result(taskName): previous task results
  // - env: environment secrets

  // Your logic here
  const result = await doSomething();

  // Return value becomes task result
  return {
    output: result,
    success: true
  };
}
```

Accessing Context

```
export default async function({ event, result, env }) {
  // Trigger event data
  const problemTitle = event().title;
  const severity = event().severity;

  // Previous task result
  const previousOutput = result('previous_task').data;

  // Environment secrets
  const apiKey = env.API_KEY;

  return { title: problemTitle };
}
```

Task Configuration

```
name: custom_javascript
type: dynatrace.automations:run-javascript
input:
  script: |
    export default async function({ event }) {
      return { processed: true };
    }
```

2. Dynatrace SDK Usage

Available SDK Clients

Client	Purpose	Import
<code>queryExecutionClient</code>	Execute DQL queries	<code>@dynatrace-sdk/client-query</code>
<code>entitiesClient</code>	Entity CRUD operations	<code>@dynatrace-sdk/client-classic-environment-v2</code>
<code>problemsClient</code>	Problem management	<code>@dynatrace-sdk/client-classic-environment-v2</code>

Client	Purpose	Import
eventsClient	Event ingestion	@dynatrace-sdk/client-classic-environment-v2
settingsClient	Settings management	@dynatrace-sdk/client-classic-environment-v2

Execute DQL Query

```
import { queryExecutionClient } from '@dynatrace-sdk/client-query';

export default async function({ event }) {
  const result = await queryExecutionClient.queryExecute({
    body: {
      query: `
        fetch logs, from: now() - 1h
        | filter loglevel == "ERROR"
        | summarize error_count = count()
      `,
      requestTimeoutMilliseconds: 30000
    }
  });

  const records = result.result.records || [];
  const errorCount = records[0]?.error_count || 0;

  return { error_count: errorCount };
}
```

Get Entity Details

```
import { entitiesClient } from '@dynatrace-sdk/client-classic-environment-v2';

export default async function({ event }) {
  const entityId = event().root_cause_entity_id;

  const entity = await entitiesClient.getEntity({
    entityId: entityId,
    fields: '+properties,+tags'
  });

  return {
    name: entity.displayName,
    type: entity.type,
    tags: entity.tags || []
  };
}
```

Add Problem Comment

```
import { problemsClient } from '@dynatrace-sdk/client-classic-environment-v2';

export default async function({ event, result }) {
  const problemId = event().display_id;
  const actionTaken = result('remediation').action;

  await problemsClient.createComment({
    problemId: problemId,
    body: {
      message: `[Automated] Remediation executed: ${actionTaken}`,
      context: 'Workflow automation'
    }
  });

  return { comment_added: true };
}
```

3. HTTP Request Patterns

HTTP Request Action

```
name: call_external_api
type: dynatrace.http:request
input:
  url: "https://api.example.com/endpoint"
  method: POST
  headers:
    Authorization: "Bearer {{ env.API_TOKEN }}"
    Content-Type: "application/json"
  body: |
    {
      "problem_id": "{{ event()['display_id'] }}",
      "severity": "{{ event()['severity'] }}",
      "title": "{{ event()['title'] }}"
    }
```

Using fetch() in JavaScript

```
export default async function({ event, env }) {
  const response = await fetch('https://api.example.com/webhook', {
    method: 'POST',
    headers: {
      'Authorization': `Bearer ${env.API_TOKEN}`,
      'Content-Type': 'application/json'
    },
    body: JSON.stringify({
      problem_id: event().display_id,
      severity: event().severity,
      title: event().title,
      timestamp: new Date().toISOString()
    })
  });

  if (!response.ok) {
    throw new Error(`HTTP ${response.status}: ${await response.text()}`);
  }

  const data = await response.json();
  return { response: data };
}
```

GET Request with Query Parameters

```
export default async function({ event, env }) {
  const params = new URLSearchParams({
    entity_id: event().root_cause_entity_id,
    from: new Date(Date.now() - 3600000).toISOString(),
    to: new Date().toISOString()
  });

  const response = await fetch(
    `https://api.example.com/metrics?${params}`,
    {
      headers: {
        'Authorization': `Bearer ${env.API_TOKEN}`
      }
    }
  );

  return await response.json();
}
```

4. Error Handling

Try-Catch Pattern

```
export default async function({ event, env }) {
  try {
    const response = await fetch('https://api.example.com/action', {
      method: 'POST',
      headers: { 'Authorization': `Bearer ${env.TOKEN}` },
      body: JSON.stringify({ id: event().display_id })
    });

    if (!response.ok) {
      const errorText = await response.text();
      return {
        success: false,
        error: `HTTP ${response.status}`,
        details: errorText
      };
    }

    return {
      success: true,
      data: await response.json()
    };
  } catch (error) {
    return {
      success: false,
      error: error.message,
      stack: error.stack
    };
  }
}
```


Retry Logic

```
async function fetchWithRetry(url, options, maxRetries = 3) {
  let lastError;

  for (let attempt = 1; attempt <= maxRetries; attempt++) {
    try {
      const response = await fetch(url, options);

      if (response.ok) {
        return response;
      }

      // Retry on 5xx errors
      if (response.status >= 500 && attempt < maxRetries) {
        await new Promise(r => setTimeout(r, 1000 * attempt));
        continue;
      }

      throw new Error(`HTTP ${response.status}`);
    } catch (error) {
      lastError = error;
      if (attempt < maxRetries) {
        await new Promise(r => setTimeout(r, 1000 * attempt));
      }
    }
  }

  throw lastError;
}

export default async function({ event, env }) {
  const response = await fetchWithRetry(
    'https://api.example.com/action',
    {
      method: 'POST',
      headers: { 'Authorization': `Bearer ${env.TOKEN}` }
    }
  );

  return await response.json();
}
```

5. Working with Data

Transform DQL Results

```
import { queryExecutionClient } from '@dynatrace-sdk/client-query';

export default async function({ event }) {
  const result = await queryExecutionClient.queryExecute({
    body: {
      query: `
        fetch logs, from: now() - 1h
        | filter loglevel == "ERROR"
        | fields timestamp, content, dt.entity.service
        | limit 100
      `
    }
  });

  const records = result.result.records || [];

  // Group by service
  const byService = records.reduce((acc, log) => {
    const service = log['dt.entity.service'] || 'unknown';
    if (!acc[service]) {
      acc[service] = [];
    }
    acc[service].push(log.content);
    return acc;
  }, {});

  // Create summary
  const summary = Object.entries(byService).map(([service, logs]) => ({
    service,
    error_count: logs.length,
    sample: logs[0]
  }));

  return {
    total_errors: records.length,
    by_service: summary
  };
}
```

Parse Event Tags

```
export default async function({ event }) {
  const tags = event().tags || [];

  // Parse key:value tags
  const tagMap = tags.reduce((acc, tag) => {
    if (tag.includes(':')) {
      const [key, value] = tag.split(':');
      acc[key] = value;
    } else {
      acc[tag] = true;
    }
  }, {});

  return {
    team: tagMap['team'] || 'unknown',
    env: tagMap['env'] || 'unknown',
    is_critical: tagMap['critical'] || false
  };
}
```

Build Dynamic Queries

```
import { queryExecutionClient } from '@dynatrace-sdk/client-query';

export default async function({ event }) {
  const entityId = event().root_cause_entity_id;
  const severity = event().severity;

  // Build query based on entity type
  let query;
  if (entityId.startsWith('SERVICE-')) {
    query = `
      fetch spans, from: now() - 1h
      | filter dt.entity.service == "${entityId}"
      | filter span.status_code >= 500
      | summarize errors = count()
    `;
  } else if (entityId.startsWith('HOST-')) {
    query = `
      fetch logs, from: now() - 1h
      | filter dt.entity.host == "${entityId}"
      | filter loglevel == "ERROR"
      | summarize errors = count()
    `;
  }

  const result = await queryExecutionClient.queryExecute({
    body: { query }
  });

  return {
    entity_type: entityId.split('-')[0],
    errors: result.result.records[0]?.errors || 0
  };
}
```

6. Integration Examples

GitHub Issue Creation

```
export default async function({ event, env }) {
  const response = await fetch(
    `https://api.github.com/repos/${env.GITHUB_REPO}/issues`,
    {
      method: 'POST',
      headers: {
        'Authorization': `token ${env.GITHUB_TOKEN}`,
        'Accept': 'application/vnd.github.v3+json',
        'Content-Type': 'application/json'
      },
      body: JSON.stringify({
        title: `[Dynatrace] ${event().title}`,
        body: `
<a id="problem-details"></a>
## Problem Details
- **Problem ID:** ${event().display_id}
- **Severity:** ${event().severity}
- **Started:** ${event().start_time}
- **Link:** [View in Dynatrace](${event().problem_url})

<a id="affected-entities"></a>
## Affected Entities
${event().affected_entity_ids.map(e => `- ${e}`).join('\n')}
`,
        labels: ['dynatrace', event().severity.toLowerCase()]
      })
    );

  const issue = await response.json();
  return { issue_number: issue.number, url: issue.html_url };
}
```

Datadog Event

```
export default async function({ event, env }) {
  const response = await fetch('https://api.datadoghq.com/api/v1/events', {
    method: 'POST',
    headers: {
      'DD-API-KEY': env.DATADOG_API_KEY,
      'Content-Type': 'application/json'
    },
    body: JSON.stringify({
      title: event().title,
      text: `Problem ${event().display_id} detected by Dynatrace`,
      alert_type: event().severity === 'CRITICAL' ? 'error' : 'warning',
      source_type_name: 'dynatrace',
      tags: ['source:dynatrace', `severity:${event().severity}`]
    })
  });

  return await response.json();
}
```

Splunk HEC Event

```
export default async function({ event, env }) {
  const response = await fetch(
    `${env.SPLUNK_HEC_URL}/services/collector/event`,
    {
      method: 'POST',
      headers: {
        'Authorization': `Splunk ${env.SPLUNK_HEC_TOKEN}`,
        'Content-Type': 'application/json'
      },
      body: JSON.stringify({
        event: {
          problem_id: event().display_id,
          title: event().title,
          severity: event().severity,
          affected_entities: event().affected_entity_ids
        },
        sourcetype: 'dynatrace:problem',
        index: 'observability'
      })
    }
  );

  return { sent: response.ok };
}
```

7. Performance Tips

Parallel Execution

```
export default async function({ event }) {
  const entityIds = event().affected_entity_ids;

  // Execute all lookups in parallel
  const results = await Promise.all(
    entityIds.map(id => getEntityDetails(id))
  );

  return { entities: results };
}
```

Limit Query Scope

```
// Bad: Fetching too much data
const result = await queryExecutionClient.queryExecute({
  body: {
    query: `fetch logs, from: now() - 7d | filter loglevel == "ERROR"`
  }
});

// Good: Limited time range and fields
const result = await queryExecutionClient.queryExecute({
  body: {
    query: `
      fetch logs, from: now() - 1h
      | filter loglevel == "ERROR"
      | fields timestamp, content
      | limit 100
    `,
    requestTimeoutMilliseconds: 30000
  }
});
```

Use Timeouts

```
// Add timeout to external calls
const controller = new AbortController();
const timeout = setTimeout(() => controller.abort(), 10000);

try {
  const response = await fetch(url, {
    signal: controller.signal,
    // ... other options
  });
  return await response.json();
} finally {
  clearTimeout(timeout);
}
```


Monitor JavaScript Task Performance

```
// JavaScript task execution times
fetch events, from: now() - 7d
| filter event.type == "automation.task.execution"
| filter contains(task.type, "javascript")
| summarize
    avg_duration = avg(task.duration),
    max_duration = max(task.duration),
    p95_duration = percentile(task.duration, 95),
    total = count(),
    by:{workflow.name, task.name}
| sort avg_duration desc
| limit 20
```

```
// HTTP request task errors
fetch events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.type == "automation.task.execution"
| filter contains(task.type, "http") or contains(task.type, "javascript")
| filter task.status == "FAILED"
| fields timestamp, workflow.name, task.name, task.error
| sort timestamp desc
| limit 20
```

Next Steps

With custom integrations ready, learn governance:

Recommended Path

1. **WFLOW-09: Security, Governance & Monitoring** - Production best practices

Key Takeaways

- **JavaScript actions** enable custom logic
- **Dynatrace SDK** provides typed API access
- **HTTP requests** integrate any REST API
- **Error handling** is critical for reliability
- **Performance** matters - limit query scope, use parallelism

Summary

In this notebook, you learned:

- JavaScript action structure and context
 - Dynatrace SDK clients and methods
 - HTTP request patterns (GET, POST, auth)
 - Error handling and retry logic
 - Data transformation patterns
 - Integration examples (GitHub, Datadog, Splunk)
 - Performance optimization tips
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References

- [JavaScript Action](#)
 - [HTTP Request Action](#)
 - [Dynatrace SDK](#)
 - [DQL Reference](#)
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